

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DCCED

Date: 5/20/2026

Bill Number: HB 216

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): TRANSFER OF RAILROAD LAND TO WHITTIER

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

Discussions remain ongoing between the City of Whittier and ARRC in pursuit of a mutually beneficial land sale. In order for ARRC to complete a land sale transaction, legislative approval is required; this legislation provides that approval for a defined set of parcels within Whittier. Any final transaction will be subject to agreement by both the City of Whittier and the ARRC Board of Directors.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

This bill would provide legislative authorization for the Alaska Railroad to sell or exchange select parcels of land to the City of Whittier for fair market value, pending approval by the ARRC Board of Directors. As outlined in AS.42.40.352, prior to approving the sale or exchange of railroad land, the ARRC Board must find that the land in question is not necessary for railroad purposes and such sale is in the best interest of the State.

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Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 would authorize ARRC to convey the surface estate of five parcels of land to the City of Whittier at fair market value, and provides descriptions of the land in question; and clarifies that any sale of exchange of ARRC land must be approved by the ARRC Board of Directors in accordance with AS 42.40.

Section 2 notes that the Act would take effect immediately under AS 01.10.070(c).

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

Companion bill – SB 191 (TRANSFER OF RAILROAD LAND TO WHITTIER) sponsored by Senator Giessel.

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

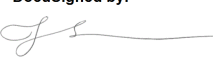
The City of Whittier strongly supports this legislation. Chugach Alaska Corporation also submitted a letter of support. We are unaware of any opposition.

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

City of Whittier.

Commissioner’s Signature:

DocuSigned by:

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Date: 5/21/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor’s Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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